meetup

23RD OCTOBER 2026

SOUTH COAST USER GROUP MEET UP

HILTON HOTEL, UTILITA BOWL, SOUTHAMPTON

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Microsoft

Sheep herding with Agent 365

Edine Olijve-Watkinson – InSpark
Kevin McDonnell - Avanade

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SPEAKER

Introducing



Edine Olijve-Watkinson

Consultant // InSpark

Does not live on a farm

Focus	Awards	Connect
Copilot and agent governance, datamigrations (yes, still a thing)	Copilot and Purview MVP	Linkedin: edine-olijve

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SPEAKER

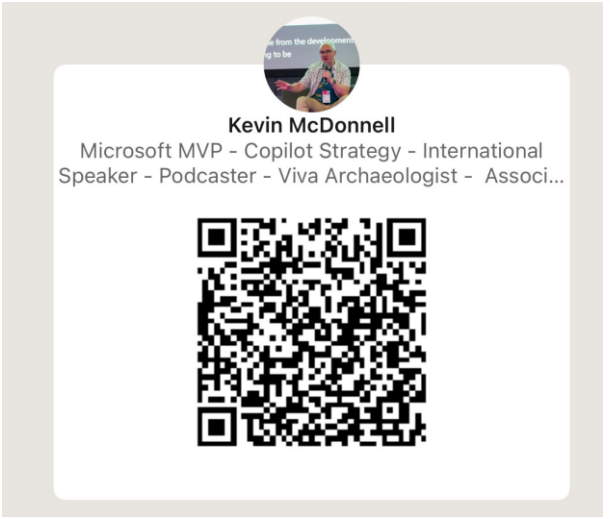
Introducing



Kevin McDonnell

Associate Director // Avanade

Move ahead with agents,
But with the right guardrails



Focus

Building strategies for Copilot and Agents, establishing the right Agentic Guardrails

Awards

Copilot and Copilot Extensibility MVP

Connect

QR Code above for LinkedIn
Kevmcdonk everywhere else

Microsoft® MVP Most Valuable Professional

THE COPILOT CONNECTION
A PODCAST ABOUT GENERATIVE AI IN THE WORKPLACE

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COLLABDAYS

Agenda

TODAY'S AGENDA

UPDATE TO BE NATHAN AND AARON

The good



The bad



The UGLY



Questions



Why Agent 365?




Your first agent
Your agent’s friends
More agents


Even more agents


Scotland in
2025
5.56m people
6.5m sheep


Escaping boundaries


External agents
Google
aws
salesforce


Out of date and no value
Google
aws
salesforce

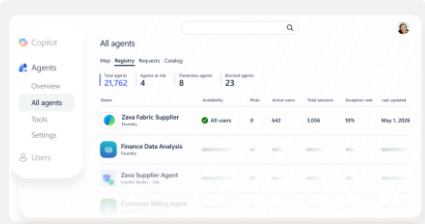

Out of date and no value
aws
Google
salesforce
XXX


Why Agent 365?

Agent 365 provides a distributed control plane for agent operations

Microsoft Agent 365

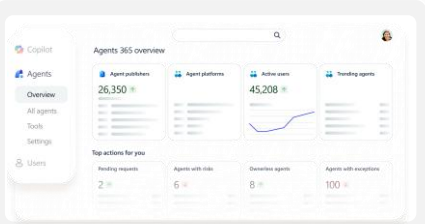
The control plane for agents



IT Admin

"Control, govern & monitor agents across the org"

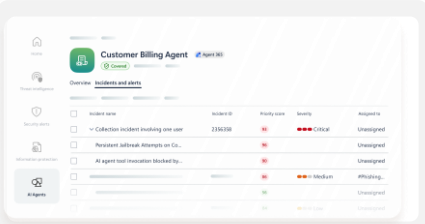
Microsoft 365 Admin Center



Business Leaders

"Deliver measurable outcomes and ROI"

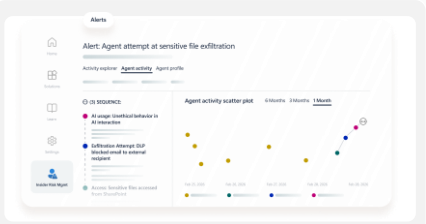
Agent Dashboard



SecOps Analyst

"Detect threats & secure agent activity in real time"

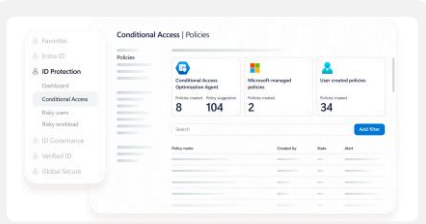
Microsoft Defender



Data Security

"Protect data & enforce compliance policies"

Microsoft Purview



Identity Manager

"Manage identities & access for agents and users"

Microsoft Entra

Shared Foundation

- Registry & Identity
- Access Control & Policies
- Observability
- Tools Gateway
- Run-time Protection
- Security

How the day will flow

- We will tell you about agent governance with Agent 365
- You have a set of labs to complete
- But you don’t have to do them
- You can just listen
- Or just investigate what is there instead of building

The day is yours to decide

What you could do today

- Create two agents – one Agent Builder and one Copilot Studio
- Add a skill to the plugin registry
- Optional - Connect a Salesforce instance or other platform
- Build Agent Management Rules
- Build an Agent Blueprint
- Locate agent activities in DSPM and Audit Log within Purview
- Investigate Defender Security Signals
- Set up Communication Instructions

Let’s get to know each other

Name
Company/role
What do you know about agents?
Why are you here? AKA what do you want to know about agent governance



The story

- Sheep are running wild in Murrayfield
- Farmers making too much money
- Two key agents
  - **Sheep Sales agent**
  - **Complaints Tracker**

How can

Agent 365

help these run effectively?



Let's test it

Email a complaint to sheep@mcd79.com

Complaints Tracker – Baaabara Streisand

Your Autopilot



01

Always-on conversational layer

Receives and responds to Teams messages and emails in real time, with native channel fluency.

02

Tool-enabled action

Plugs into operational systems and APIs to investigate, triage and resolve cases without handoffs.

03

Governed like a hire

Performance, quality and compliance are monitored and managed with the same rigor as human employees.

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Let's test it

Email a complaint to **sheep@mcd79.com**

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Building an agent with blueprints



Blueprint = DNA

One recipe
for a sheep.

Instance = Dolly

Dolly.
And Dolly.
And Dolly.

Identity = Blueprint + Instance

The ear tag

One sheep, many Dollys

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THE BAD

What doesn’t Agent 365 do



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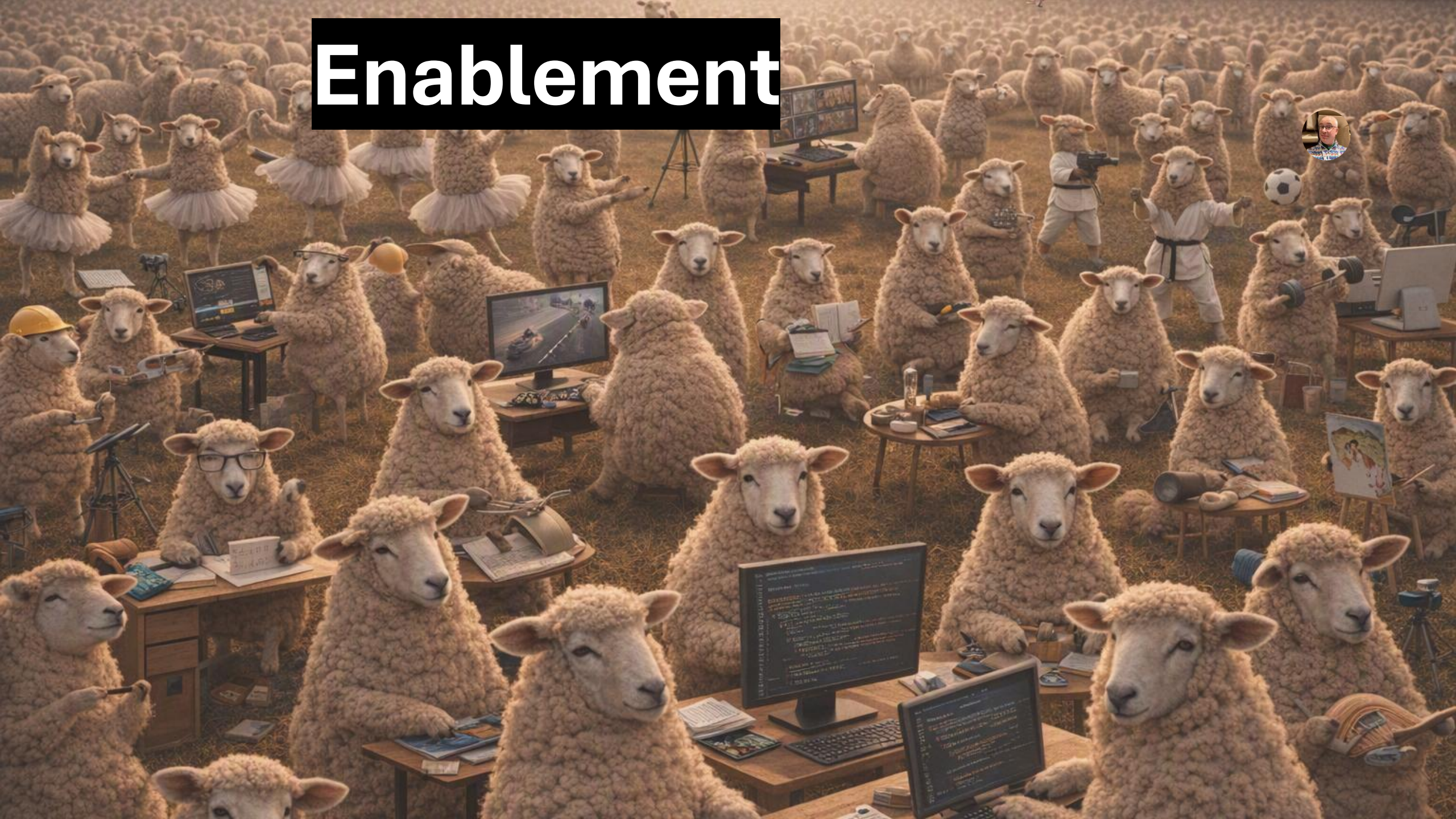
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What does Agent 365
not do?


People and processes

Enablement



FinOps/Cost Management



End user tools





More than one control plane still

Where A365 sits

1 Build, evaluate, test

Before live

- Enable people
- Building an agent
- Running evaluations
- Security testing and red teaming
- Approval gates
- Responsible AI

2 Manage

When in production

- Activity logs
- Threat monitoring
- Auditing
- Agent registry
- Access control



Microsoft Agent 365

The control plane for agents

THE UGLY

Yup, let's talk licensing



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Agent 365 and E7

Microsoft Agent 365
The control plane for agents

How many licences do you need, and what comes in each tier? The answers.

Agent 365
Standalone add-on

£11.50
per user / month, billed yearly

- Governance & security layer for agents
- Needs E5, Defender + Purview FLW, or Business Premium
- One licence covers all of a user's agents

Microsoft 365 E7
The Frontier Suite

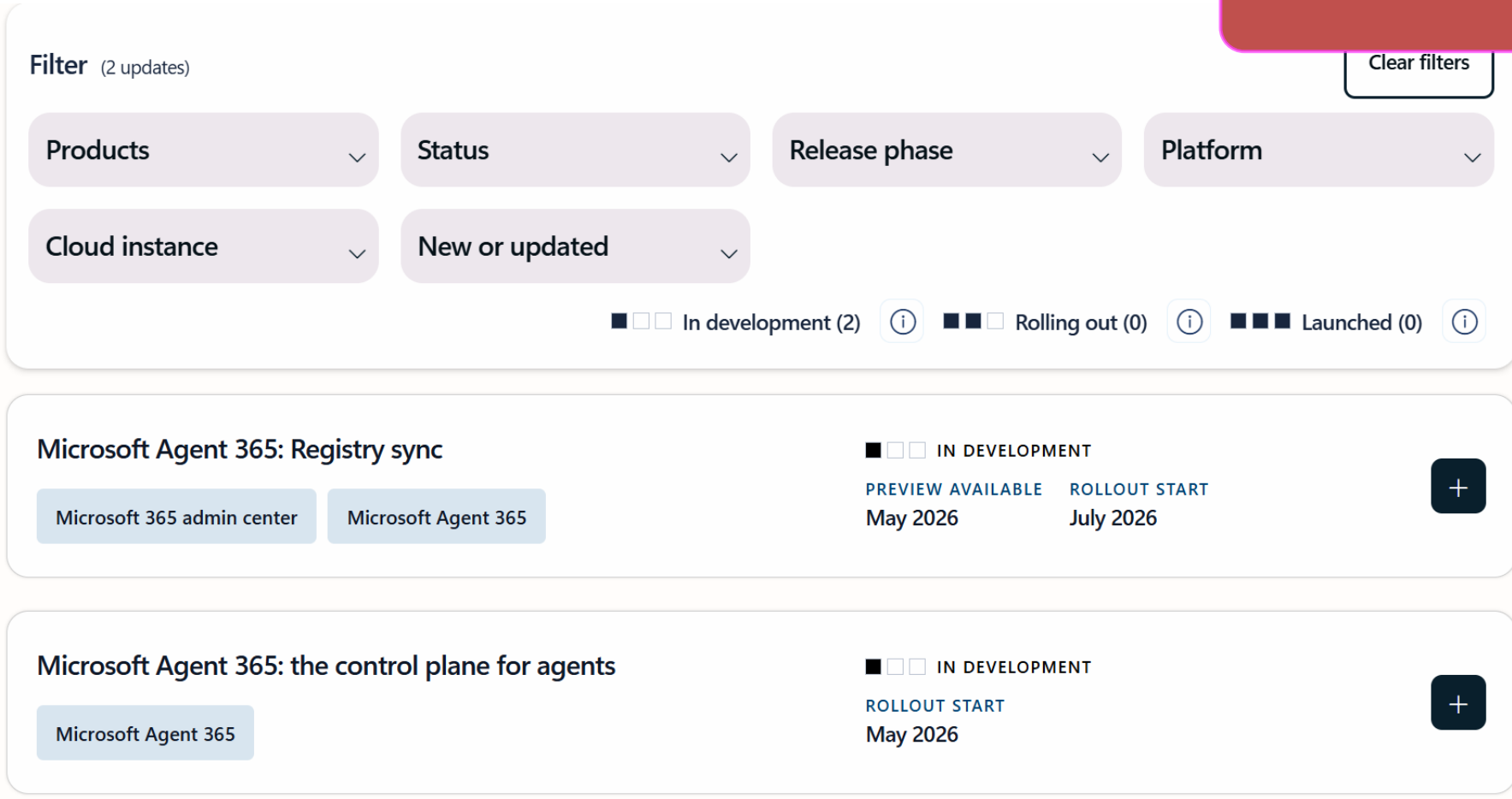
£81.60
per user / month, billed yearly

- E5 + Copilot + Entra Suite + Agent 365
- ~15% cheaper than buying the parts separately
- Generally available since 1 May 2026

Agent 365 teammate licence (preview): gives an agent its own identity - mailbox, OneDrive and org-chart presence - so it works alongside people as a full "agent user". Available today through the Frontier preview programme.

Roadmap...

**Unchanged since May…
Until…**



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The session buster – thanks Microsoft



What's new in Agent 365 - September 2026 | Microsoft Community Hub

- Agent 365 is the central home for Usage Based Billing – yay, more cost
- Set model choice per spending policy
- Understand Cowork value with Insights
- AI filters in Agent Registry
- Agent Management Rules – more to come here

And more to come with Ignite coming up in mid November…

IN SUMMARY

1. Agent 365 is an awesome idea
2. But it doesn't do everything
3. And it won't be for everyone

Still on you: you still need to define your guardrails and governance - somehow.



Baaaaaaaaaaaa…

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